

SUBJECT PROPERTY | EXTERIOR STREETVIEW

VERDICT: DO NOT BUY (HOLD) / DO NOT BUY (FLIP) | INVESTMENT SCORE: 25/100

PROPERTY & VALUATION SNAPSHOT

Property Details	Data
Property Type	2-Family
Beds	5
Baths	3
Year Built	1905

Valuation Metric	Estimated Value
Asking Price	$780,000
Recommended MAO	$450,000
Est. FMV	$571,330 - $606,670
Est. ARV	$850,000
Est. Renovation Budget	$133,500

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

169 Walnut Street is a 1905-built, 2-Family property located in a highly desirable Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) and 'College Town' pocket of Bloomfield, NJ. While the asset boasts strong spatial fundamentals and cosmetic interior updates, it is severely overpriced at $780,000, resulting in deep negative leverage and mathematically unviable flip margins. The property generates an As-Is Gross Rent of $60,000, but requires a $133,500 Renovation Budget to cure structural liabilities, including a foundation-threatening tree and severe interior egress hazards. Even after stabilization, the asset suffers a Stabilized Cash Bleed of ($657) per month and a failing DSCR of 0.81. At the current asking price, the deal presents catastrophic financial risk and requires a massive price reduction to achieve viability.

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FINANCIAL SYNTHESIS & STRATEGY COMPARISON

The financial underwriting for 169 Walnut Street reveals a toxic asset at the current $780,000 asking price. For a buy-and-hold investor, the property suffers from severe negative leverage, where the 6.0% cost of debt significantly outpaces the property's 3.74% stabilized Cap Rate. Even after injecting $133,500 to stabilize the asset and push rents to the top of the market ($3,000/unit), the property fails to cover its debt obligations, resulting in a DSCR of 0.81 and a negative monthly cash flow of ($657). The high baseline operating expenses, driven by the 1905 vintage and a $14,521 tax burden, severely compress the Net Operating Income (NOI).

For a short-term flip strategy, the deal is mathematically unviable. The seller is attempting to capture retail, move-in-ready pricing while passing off $133,500 in necessary structural, safety, and modernization liabilities to the buyer. This results in a deeply negative forced appreciation of ($63,500). The combined acquisition and rehabilitation costs far exceed the ceiling of the After Repair Value (ARV), leading to a projected net loss of over $242,000. To achieve a standard 1.20 DSCR or a profitable flip margin, an investor would need to negotiate a catastrophic purchase price reduction down to approximately $450,000.

STRATEGY A: BUY & HOLD (LONG-TERM)

UNDERWRITING ASSUMPTIONS

Underwriting Assumption	Value
Purchase Price	$780,000
Down Payment %	25%
Interest Rate	6.0%
Amortization Period	30 Years
Expense Ratio	50%

OPERATING PRO-FORMA

Line Item	Current (As-Is)	Stabilized
Gross Rent	$60,000	$72,000
Vacancy Loss	$3,000	$3,600
EGI	$57,000	$68,400
Operating Expenses	$28,500	$34,200
NOI	$28,500	$34,200
Debt Service	$42,088	$42,088
Monthly Cash Flow	($1,132)	($657)

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YIELD & RETURN METRICS

Metric	Current (As-Is)	Stabilized
Cap Rate	3.65%	3.74%
Cash-on-Cash Return	(6.22%)	(2.24%)
DSCR	0.68	0.81

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STRATEGY B: FIX & FLIP (SHORT-TERM)

HARD MONEY TERMS

Hard Money Loan Structure	Value
Loan Amount	$835,500
Total Points	$16,710
Total Interest (6 mos)	$45,953

CAPITAL REQUIREMENTS

Capital & Exit Costs	Value
Holding Costs	$14,368
Exit Costs	$68,000
Acquisition/Closing Costs	$31,200
Acquisition Fee	$2,500
Total Deal Cost	$1,092,231

PROJECTED RETURNS

Projected Flip Margin	Value
Projected ARV	$850,000
Net Profit	($242,231)
Cash-on-Cash Return	(94.35%)
Forced Appreciation	($63,500)

FIX & FLIP SENSITIVITY MATRIX

Scenario	Purchase Price	Rehab Cost	ARV	Net Profit	CoC Return
Worst Case	$819,000	$146,850	$765,000	($378,169)	(145.89%)
Base Case	$780,000	$133,500	$850,000	($242,231)	(94.35%)
Best Case	$741,000	$120,150	$935,000	($106,292)	(41.81%)

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RENOVATION & CAPEX ANALYSIS

The property presents a 'split personality' with high-quality cosmetic updates in several interior spaces masking significant deferred maintenance and severe safety hazards. The exterior requires immediate remediation of a massive evergreen tree threatening the foundation, as well as repairs to a significant hole in the older side siding to prevent water and pest intrusion. Internally, the property features 5 bedrooms and 3 bathrooms across a 2-unit configuration. Because this is an odd distribution of plumbing fixtures, the exact plumbing layout requires strict municipal verification rather than assuming how they are split between the units. Furthermore, the laundry area is situated at the top of a stairwell, creating a severe trip and fall hazard that must be relocated. The 'finished' basement requires the installation of legal egress windows to qualify as habitable space, and the disjointed HVAC system requires the addition of central air conditioning to achieve top-of-market ARV. Additionally, given the 1905 construction, all renovations must strictly address potential lead and asbestos hazards during demolition.

ITEMIZED CAPEX BUDGET

Category	Est. Cost	Priority
Exterior & Grounds	$32,000	High
Interior Renovations	$52,500	High
Basement & Compliance	$16,000	Critical
Mechanicals & Systems	$33,000	High

ESTIMATED CONSTRUCTION TIMELINE

Phase	Description	Est. Duration
Phase 1	Demolition, Tree Removal & Permitting	3 Weeks
Phase 2	Framing, Egress Windows & Laundry Relocation	2 Weeks
Phase 3	MEP Rough-In (HVAC, Electrical, Plumbing)	3 Weeks
Phase 4	Exterior Siding & Roof Replacement	2 Weeks
Phase 5	Drywall, Plaster Repair & Painting	3 Weeks
Phase 6	Interior Finishes (Kitchens, Baths, Flooring)	4 Weeks
Phase 7	Final Fixtures, Trim & Clean-up	2 Weeks
Phase 8	Final Inspections & Certificate of Occupancy	2 Weeks

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MARKET & ZONING INTELLIGENCE

Bloomfield serves as a critical 'spillover' market for buyers and renters priced out of neighboring ultra-premium markets like Montclair and Glen Ridge. The subject property is situated in a highly desirable, mixed-use residential pocket anchored by Bloomfield College, providing a built-in, recession-resistant demographic of students and faculty. Furthermore, the location is a prime example of Transit-Oriented Development (TOD), sitting roughly a half-mile from the Bloomfield Train Station, which offers a highly coveted one-seat ride to New York Penn Station. While the local crime rate of 16.04 per 1,000 residents is moderate and typical for dense transit hubs, the rental market temperature is currently 'COOL', meaning landlords must deliver premium, well-maintained units to avoid extended vacancy periods.

ENVIRONMENTAL & LOCATIONAL FACTORS

Environmental Factor	Status / Impact
Nearest Transit	0.5 Miles (Bloomfield Train Station)
Crime Rate Status	16.04 per 1,000 (Moderate)
Flood Zone	Zone X (Minimal Hazard)
Wetlands	None Identified
Contamination	Pre-1978 Lead/Asbestos Risk

UNIT MIX & PROJECTED RENT ROLL

Unit Type	Count	Current Avg Rent	Pro-Forma Rent
Unit 1 (Layout Unverified)	1	$2,500	$3,000
Unit 2 (Layout Unverified)	1	$2,500	$3,000

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TAX ASSESSMENT & APPEAL STRATEGY

The subject property currently carries an assessment of $428,100, which implies a market value of $673,537 based on the municipality's Director Ratio of 63.56%. When compared against the appraiser's True Market Value of $589,000, the Subject Ratio calculates to 72.68%. Because this ratio falls safely within the Chapter 123 Upper Limit 73.09% and Lower Limit 54.03%, the assessment is considered valid and within the common level range. Therefore, the property is not eligible for appeal reduction, and no immediate tax savings can be realized.

CHAPTER 123 TAX METRICS

Tax Assessment Metric	Value
Current Assessment	$428,100
Implied Market Value	$673,537
True Market Value	$589,000
Subject Ratio	72.68%
Director Ratio	63.56%
Upper Limit	73.09%
Lower Limit	54.03%
Est. Tax Savings	$0

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IDENTIFIED CRITICAL RISKS

- Severe negative leverage and negative cash flow at the current asking price.
- Deeply negative forced appreciation ($63,500) making a flip mathematically unviable.
- Unpermitted finished basement in a 1905 build lacking legal egress.
- Massive evergreen tree threatening the foundation and overhead power lines.
- Hazardous laundry placement blocking the primary egress stairwell.

MITIGATION STRATEGIES

- Negotiate a catastrophic price reduction to the $450,000 MAO to achieve a viable DSCR and flip margin.

- Demand a municipal Certificate of Occupancy and retroactive permits for the 2015 renovations prior to closing.

- Allocate immediate CapEx to remove the foundation-threatening tree and repair the exterior siding breach.

- Relocate the laundry appliances to a dedicated, safe space to eliminate trip and fall liabilities.

- Install legal egress windows in the basement to ensure compliance and habitability.

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DUE DILIGENCE: VERIFICATION MATRIX

The following matrix highlights critical structural, zoning, or environmental discrepancies between municipal public records and the marketed property details.

Data Point	Public Record	Listing Claim	Risk Level
Unit Count	Class 2 (2-FAM)	2-Family (Implied via 2 Kitchens)	LOW
Year Built	1905	1905 (Effective Year 2015)	LOW
Basement Status	Verification Needed	Finished Basement	MODERATE
Parking Configuration	Verification Needed	1-Car Width / 4 Tandem Spaces	MODERATE

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SALES COMPARABLES (RECENT CLOSINGS)

Address	Sale Price	SqFt	Beds	Baths	Sale Date
413 Beardsley Ave	$860,000	N/A	N/A	N/A	04/02/2026
180 Jerome Place	$830,000	N/A	N/A	N/A	03/11/2026
412 Berkeley Ave	$860,000	N/A	N/A	N/A	02/27/2026
252-254 Montgomery St	$850,000	2176	7	4	02/19/2026
200 Montgomery St	$870,000	N/A	N/A	N/A	02/13/2026
48 Spruce St	$825,000	N/A	N/A	N/A	02/02/2026

RENTAL MARKET TRENDS

Rental Trend Metric	Value
Median Rent	$2,500
Available Rentals	145
Market Temp	COOL
Yearly Change	$100

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